

# Aguko Osman & Co. Advocates - Website Development Documentation

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Design and build approach

## 1. Project Scope

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This documents the approach for designing and building a professional website for **Aguko Osman & Co. Advocates**, a Nairobi-based law firm, replacing their existing 2020-era WordPress site. The firm's own build will be done by the client; this documentation exists so that intent, decisions, and constraints are recorded in one place before implementation.

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## 2. Firm & Person Information Gathered

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### Firm

- Name: Aguko Osman & Co. Advocates
  - Location: Nairobi, Kenya
  - Existing site: agukoosman.com (copyright-dated 2020)
  - Regional reach: associate firm relationships across East Africa for cross-border matters
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### Practice Areas

Dispute Resolution & Litigation · Corporate & Commercial Law · Real Estate & Conveyancing · Banking, Finance & Capital Markets · Employment & Labour · Family Law · Tax Advisory · Debt Collection & Recovery · Intellectual Property · Government, Policy & Legislative Drafting · Telecommunications, Mining, Energy & Resources · Forensic & Litigation Consulting

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### The Advocates

**Gad Aguko — Senior Partner** - LL.B, University of Nairobi - Postgraduate Diploma in Law, Kenya School of Law - Advocate of the High Court of Kenya - Currently pursuing the Certified Public Secretary course (CPS/CS, KASNEB) - Named in The Lawyer Africa's "Top Real Estate and Finance Lawyers in Kenya 2023" and "Top Litigation Lawyers in Kenya 2026" listings

**Abdikadir Osman Mohamed — Managing Partner** - LL.B, University of Nairobi - Advocate of the High Court of Kenya - Certified Public Mediator, Mediation Training Institute of Kenya (CPM, MTI-K)

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### Contact Details

| Field            | Value               |
|------------------|---------------------|
| Phone / WhatsApp | +254 743 923 365    |
| Email            | info@agukoosman.com |

|         |                |
|---------|----------------|
| Website | agukoosman.com |
|---------|----------------|

**Unresolved address discrepancy** — two different office addresses appear across public listings, both citing “5th Floor, Room 501”: 1. Pioneer House, Moi Avenue, Nairobi Central 2. Akai Plaza, Thika Road (Exit 7), Nairobi

This must be confirmed directly with the firm before the new site goes live — one listing is likely outdated.

### Public Record Note

The firm appears in *Aguko Osman & Company Advocates v Georgiou & another* [2024] KEHC 12455 (KLR), a Milimani Commercial Courts ruling on taxation of advocate’s costs. This is a fees matter involving the firm itself, not a client matter — it will **not** be referenced anywhere on the site.

## 3. Legal Constraints Governing All Content

The **Advocates (Marketing and Advertising) Rules, 2014** (Advocates Act) shape every piece of copy on the site. These are treated as hard constraints, not style suggestions:

- No claims of superiority (“best,” “leading,” “No. 1”)
- No client testimonials or endorsements
- No comparisons with other advocates or firms
- No case outcomes, win rates, or settlement figures used as a selling point
- No solicitation-style language calculated to unfairly attract business
- Factual third-party recognition (e.g., a named legal directory’s listing) is treated as acceptable when stated plainly, but never featured as a headline claim
- All copy intended for review by a partner or compliance officer before publishing, particularly the homepage, About page, and any “why work with us” content

**Data Protection Act, 2019** governs the contact form: - A Privacy Policy will be published explaining what data is collected and why - No pre-checked marketing consent boxes - Registration with the Office of the Data Protection Commissioner (ODPC) considered if applicable thresholds are met

## 4. Site Structure

| Page             | Purpose                                                                               |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Home             | Firm statement, entry points to top practice areas, primary call-to-action            |
| About            | Firm story, working style (direct partner access, associate network), office location |
| Practice Areas   | One page per area — plain-language process explanation, ending in a CTA               |
| Advocates / Team | Full bios: education, admission year, certifications — no comparative language        |
|                  |                                                                                       |

|              |                                                                                 |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Insights     | Commentary on legislation and court decisions — main SEO and credibility driver |
| Contact      | Address, map, phone/WhatsApp, email, hours, working inquiry form                |
| Legal footer | Privacy Policy, Terms of Use                                                    |

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## 5. Design Philosophy — Countering the “AI-Generated” Look

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The explicit goal is a site that reads like a chambers’ letterhead or a print publication — editorial and restrained — rather than a generic SaaS landing page. Concretely, that means:

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### No gradients, anywhere

No linear-gradient or radial-gradient fills, no glassmorphism (translucent cards over blurred color transitions). Every fill is a single flat, solid color. Section changes happen via a hard cut to a different flat color block, not a fade.

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### Depth without blur or glow

No drop-shadows or soft glows used to fake elevation. Separation between elements comes from:

- A deliberate, limited color palette
- Generous whitespace
- Thin hairline rules (1px, low-opacity) between sections instead of card borders

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### A small, deliberate palette — never a default component-library rainbow

One accent color only, used sparingly (links, one CTA state, small marks) — never as a large fill, which is what usually drives the “needs a gradient to feel less flat” impulse in AI-generated design.

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### Palette used (flat colors only)

| Name                | Hex                 | Role                                                 |
|---------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Paper               | #F1ECDF             | Page background                                      |
| Ink                 | #22231E             | Body text, borders, seal mark                        |
| Chambers Green      | #223B2E             | Primary buttons, hover states                        |
| Ledger Green (deep) | #16261D             | Contact section background                           |
| Brass               | #A9762E             | Single accent — links, kicker text, dark-section CTA |
| Stone               | #6E6A5C             | Secondary/muted text                                 |
| Hairline            | rgba(34,35,30,0.15) | Dividers                                             |

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## Layout choices that avoid generic template feel

- No rounded-corner “SaaS cards” for practice areas or team members — hairline-divided rows instead
- No stock “gavel and scales” imagery — restrained typographic/graphic treatment until real photography is available
- Numbered elements (e.g., “01 / 02 / 03”) used only where content is genuinely a small, fixed list of distinct points — never as decoration
- Serif display type (Source Serif 4) for headings paired with a plain sans (Inter) for body text, to read as legal/editorial rather than tech-startup

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## Visual QA step

Beyond checking the CSS contains no gradient rules, the rendered result is checked for value contrast between adjacent flat-color sections — colors too close in value read as muddy, too far apart reads jarring — since “no gradient” alone doesn’t guarantee a good-looking flat design.

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## 6. Trust and Credibility Elements to Implement

- LSK admission year and practising status shown on each advocate’s bio
- Firm’s physical office address (once confirmed) — not a P.O. box only
- Real photography of partners and office once available, replacing any placeholder/typographic treatment
- Downloadable firm profile (PDF) for corporate clients doing due diligence
- Anonymized scenario-based content (“a commercial client faced X...”) instead of outcome-bragging, to build credibility while staying inside the advertising rules
- Regularly published Insights articles (even monthly) as the strongest ongoing credibility signal
- Factual listing of any published articles or speaking engagements by the partners

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## 7. Usability and Technical Requirements

- Mobile-first layout and testing — majority of Kenyan traffic is mobile
- WhatsApp Business click-to-chat button alongside the contact form
- Stated response-time expectation near the contact form
- Multiple contact channels offered (form, phone, WhatsApp, email)
- HTTPS/SSL required — non-HTTPS is flagged as “not secure” by browsers and is disqualifying for a law firm
- Fast load time on average mobile data speeds (image compression, minimal JS)
- Google Business Profile fully completed and linked from the site
- `LegalService / Attorney` schema.org structured data for search engines
- Privacy-respecting analytics (e.g., Plausible or GA4 with proper consent handling)
- `.co.ke` domain registered via a KENIC-accredited registrar, alongside the existing `.com`

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## 8. Hosting Recommendation

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Safaricom Cloud Services shared hosting — **Silver tier** (2 GB storage, 50 email accounts, Ksh 2,500/year) recommended over Bronze (500 MB, 10 email accounts, Ksh 1,500/year): the incremental cost is small and the extra email accounts and storage headroom cover multiple partner email addresses, team photography, downloadable PDFs, and a future Insights section without needing to upgrade later.

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## 9. Open Items Requiring Client Confirmation Before Launch

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- ☐ Confirm the firm's current chambers address (Pioneer House vs. Akai Plaza discrepancy)
  - ☐ Obtain real photography of both partners and the office
  - ☐ Confirm final practice-area list and any areas to add or remove
  - ☐ Partner sign-off on all published copy against the Advocates (Marketing and Advertising) Rules, 2014
  - ☐ Decide on hosting tier and register `.co.ke` domain
  - ☐ Confirm whether ODPC registration is required based on data-processing thresholds
  - ☐ Provide or approve initial Insights articles for launch
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## 10. Deliverables Produced So Far

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1. General guide to building a Kenyan law firm website (compliance, structure, technical options)
2. Research brief compiling public information on the firm and both advocates, including the address discrepancy
3. Two working HTML site builds (initial version and a revised flat-color version with no gradients)
4. This documentation